with the French in India then brought him into conflict with the EICo, leading to what became known as the Second Anglo-Mysore War of 1779–84. With his father's death in 1782, Tipu stepped into his shoes and continued Hyder Ali's policy of expansionism by attacking the kingdom of Travancore.

The first obstacle that Tipu's army encountered was the fort at the river-crossing of Kuttippuram, north of Thrissur and Cochin, where the two-thousand-strong Nair garrison was starved into surrender, forcibly circumcised and made to complete the ceremony of conversion by eating beef. Hindu and Jain temples were fired on Tipu's orders and cattle slaughtered in the temple premises.[12] As word of Tipu's actions spread, towns and villages were abandoned and refugees began to flee south. A Portuguese missionary named Fra Paulino da San Bartolomeo, then based in Cochin, afterwards set down an account of what he was told (albeit hearsay):

> That barbarian Tipu Sultan tied the naked Christians and Hindus to the legs of elephants and made the elephants to move around till the bodies of the helpless victims were torn to pieces. Temples and churches were ordered to be burned down, desecrated and destroyed. Christian and Hindu women were forced to marry Mohammadans and similarly their men were forced to marry Mohammadan women. Those Christians who refused to be honoured with Islam, were ordered to be killed by hanging immediately. These atrocities were told to me by the victims of Tipu Sultan who escaped from the clutches of his army and reached Varappuzha, which is the centre of Carmelite Christian Mission. I myself helped many victims to cross the Varappuzha River by boats.